



DEALER BEST PRACTICE SERIES

Getting Started with MCTS

Application Maintenance Site Management Component Rebuild **Component Life Management** Safety MARC Management

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1.0 Introduction

The Major Component Tracking System (MCTS) is a Web based system designed to monitor major component status and history from the time a new component is installed new until the component is eventually scrapped.

MCTS is a user-friendly tool that allows dealers to:

- Track major components and critical parts from cradle-to-grave.
- Document component lives and reasons for replacement.
- Identify component location on prime product at any time.
- Provide critical part location within components at any time.
- Identify component and critical part current and total life hours.

The component data is stored in a central MCTS database. When a prime product is shipped from the factory, the MCTS system records the component serial numbers installed in that product. As the component begins its active life, the dealer will enter maintenance records into the system to track the movement of the component from product to product. Note that MCTS is a component tracking system – one of the most difficult things to do when using MCTS is to change focus from machine to component. The next most difficult is deciding when and how to get started.

Prior to using MCTS, the dealer should fully understand that a commitment to keeping data current comes with a commitment to use MCTS. For any database of this kind to maintain high quality data, the participating dealers must be consistent and committed.

This Best Practice contains the process for getting started in using MCTS.

2.0 Best Practice Description

The initial decision and commitment to use MCTS to track components has been made. What comes next?

The initial decisions in the MCTS tracking process are:

1. Identify which components are to be tracked.
2. Determine how the data will be submitted to MCTS.
3. Appoint the MCTS Dealer Contact.
4. Determine who will be responsible for entering and maintaining the MCTS data.
5. Set-up timeline
6. Train all MCTS Dealer Administrators and MCTS Dealer Users.

3.0 Implementation Steps

1. **Which components are to be tracked?** MCTS currently offers a list of component types to be tracked. If there is a component the dealer wishes to track that is not on this list, contact the MCTS System Administrator to request that it be added. The list is also on the second tab of the MCTS Data Input Spreadsheet attached to this document. Caterpillar suggests starting

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with the major powertrain components (engine, transmission, torque converter, final drive, differential and wheel groups). The dealer may want to start with a specific fleet or set of machines covered under contract with Caterpillar.

- 2. How will the data be submitted to MCTS?** Data may be entered in MCTS by several methods, including Manual Entry, MCTS/Manager Interface, Cat Mailbox Interface, or, for historical data, the MCTS Data Spreadsheet.

Manual Entry directly into the website.

Access the Create pages via Create Menu.



Enter the serial number and date of the operation you wish to enter.

Home > Create Major Component Operation: Step 1

Enter a major component serial number and the related operation date for the remove or install.

Create Major Component Operation: Step 1

Main Store Dealer Code: **Dealer Code and Name**

Serial Number: [select](#)

Operation Date:

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Fill in the requested data and click Save

Home > Create Major Component Operation: Step 1 > Create Major Component Operation: Step 2

Create Major Component Operation: Step 2

Header Information:

Serial Number:	6LK03010	Manufacturer:	CAT	Component Dealer/Customer ID:
Major Component Type:	Engine	Description:		Scrap Date:

Based on the date entered, 'Remove' is the suggested type for this operation.

Operation Detail:

Main Store Dealer Code: **Dealer Code and Name**

Operation Date: 17-Apr-2007

Operation Type:

Operation Detail:

SMU: Hours

Fuel: Gallons

Location On Prime Product:

Prime Product S/N: [select](#)

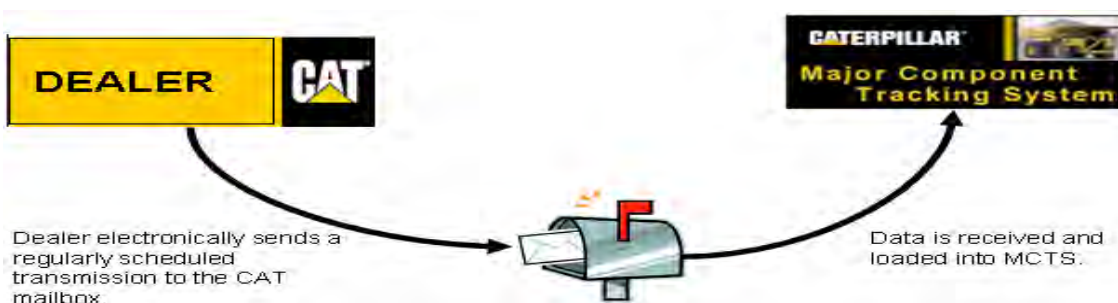
Prime Product SMU: Hours

Work Order No:

Job Site:

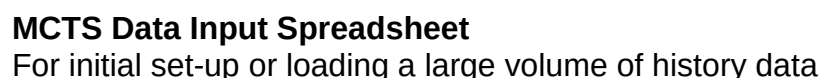
Notes:

Cat Mailbox Interface from existing Dealer component tracking system



MCTS / Manager Interface

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MCTS hort Spreadsheets - Hktp W Data 2-15-07.xls

3. MCTS Dealer Contact

This person is the single person responsible for MCTS correspondence, error reports, etc. Any requests for access to MCTS must come from the appointed MCTS Dealer Contact person so the dealership can maintain control over their own access list. When the MCTS Dealer Contact person requests access for other users, they must include: Name, CWS ID, and type of access. The two types of access for MCTS are Dealer Administrator (with ability to enter, edit, and view) and Dealer User (view only).

The MCTS Dealer Contact person is also the one responsible for or who delegates responsibility for completing documentation for MCTS and training others at the dealership.

4. Who will be entering and maintaining the MCTS data?

The dealership must decide who will be entering and maintaining data for the dealership. It is recommended that a limited number of people have administrative rights to reduce the risk of data errors. This person is usually the same one as who will be providing the set-up information. At some dealerships, the Dealer Contact person also enters and maintains the data. At others, a group is responsible for data entry and one person serves as the MCTS Dealer Contact. The MCTS Contact person could be in a variety of different roles: CSA/MARC, Central Planning/Components, Product Support, Service Department, Forecasting, Operations, Technical Support, CRC – the dealer must decide where is the best fit.

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5. Set-Up

Dealer Profile Form

The first document that must be provided to the MCTS System Administrator is the Dealer Profile. This form contains all the information for the MCTS System Administrator to set up MCTS for data entry. A partial example of this data can be found on the Dealer Profile page (under Reports) in MCTS. The MCTS Dealer Contact person will receive an annual review requesting confirmation that the Dealer Profile information is up-to-date and correct. The names and type of access for each MCTS user at the dealer must be reviewed. Additionally, customer and job site information can be entered, which will populate the drop down menus within MCTS. The Dealer Profile page in MCTS is maintained by the MCTS System Administrator.

Dealer Profile

Test Dealer

Fuel Unit Of Measure:
Gallons

Cust Name	Job Site	Type
Demo Customer One	Demo Mine 1	Coal
Demo Customer One	Demo Mine 2	Gold
Demo Customer One	Demo Mine 3	Copper
Demo Customer One	Unknown	Unknown/Other
Demo Customer Three	Demo Mine 4	Tar Sands
Demo Customer Three	Demo Mine 5	Kimberlite
Demo Customer Three	Demo Mine 6	Silver
Demo Customer Three	Unknown	Unknown/Other
Demo Customer Two	Demo Mine 1	Coal
Demo Customer Two	Demo Mine 2	Gold
Demo Customer Two	Demo Mine 3	Copper

Tracked Models

416B
416C
777D
793
793B
980G
988G
982D
992G
B350UNKNOWN
CD550
D9N

Tracked Components

Differential
Engine
Torque Converter
Transmission
Truck Body
Used Differential

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Submitting Data

Once the MCTS System Administrator receives the dealer information and adds the dealer to the list, the system is ready to accept data. MCTS already contains first install information from the factory (component serial number, prime product serial number, build date, dealer code). All other information such as location on host, customer, and job site data can be added at the time the dealer receives the machine. This data can be input by using the “edit” function at the end of each operation line, or can be updated with the first removal operation.

If the dealership has chosen to submit historical component life data via the MCTS Input Spreadsheet, the spreadsheet should be e-mailed to the MCTS System Administrator after the system is initially set up. The System Administrator will perform a data integrity check and then it will be loaded into MCTS. At this time, only the MCTS System Administrator and users from the originating dealership may see the spreadsheet data (the component life history page is marked “Spreadsheet Load”). After any errors have been corrected, it will be released for general view by all participating dealers.

Component History [\[edit header\]](#)

Serial Number: R460ATYDR1017 Manufacturer: CAT Component Dealer/Customer ID: ATYDR1017
 Component Type: Differential Description: Cumulative Component SMU: 6,181
 Status: **Spreadsheet Load**
 Notes: None

[View Current Status](#) [Printable View](#) [Show Critical Parts](#)

Operation History

Oper Date	Oper	Oper Desc	Maj Comp SMU (Hours)	Fuel Usage (Gallons)	Work Order No	Location on Prime Prod	Prime Prod S/N	Prime Prod Sales Mdl	Prime Prod Dr/Cust Id	Prime Prod Mfr	Prime Prod SMU (Hours)	Cust Name	Job Site	Type	Dir	Notes
15-Jan-2005	I	Dealer Rebuild	11,178	0	000000	Rear	ATY00603	793C	ATY00603	CAT	0	Drummond Coal	Pribbenow	Coal	R460	None [edit]
14-Nov-2004	R	Failure	6,181	0	000000	Rear	ATY00646	793C	ATY00646	CAT	0	Drummond Coal	Pribbenow	Coal	R460	None [edit]
29-Jan-2004	I	New	0	0	000000	Rear	ATY00646	793C	ATY00646	CAT	0	Drummond Coal	Pribbenow	Coal	R460	None [edit]

[Create Major Comp Operation](#)

6. Training

MCTS is not difficult to use, but it is very beneficial to learn the rules of data entry and business rules for required fields. A training session can be conducted via Sametime or in person. The MCTS Dealer Contact person and any persons responsible for entering and editing the data at dealer should attend.

4.0 Benefits

MCTS has evolved since its initial introduction in 2002. Dealer feedback has helped improve the system and increase usability. Caterpillar has also developed additional ways to assist the Dealer with this process. This Best Practice includes some of those tips and tools to help make the process a little clearer and easier.

5.0 Resources Required

Access to MCTS

Personnel – 1+, as determined by the dealer

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6.0 Supporting Attachments / References

MCTS Data Input Spreadsheet and Instruction Letter  
MCTS Dealer Profile Form 
MCTS Introduction PowerPoint 

7.0 Related Best Practices

[0906-3.1-1020 MCTS Used to Monitor and Manage Component Life](#)

8.0 Acknowledgements

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